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Hiring Manager

DoorDash People Applications

Dear Hiring Manager,

My name is Ajay Venkatesh — finishing my M.S. in Computer Engineering at NYU, with several years of production software experience: a few years at PwC in Bengaluru, a summer SDE internship at Amazon, and ongoing on-campus work at NYU's Novel AI Technologies. My focus has been on full-stack application engineering, the data layer underneath, and the patient end-to-end ownership that enterprise-internal tools actually demand.

The People Applications posting reads like a description of how I already work. **React** is where I spend my time on the product surface; **Node.js / Express, Python, and Java** are where I live on the backend; and I've shipped microservices on AWS with **Docker** and CI/CD across multiple projects. At NYU I shipped a customer-facing analytics platform end-to-end — **React, Node.js, REST APIs on Docker / EC2**, with Stripe billing, role-based access, and row-level security delivered to multiple paying clients. At Campus Mesh I built **Node.js microservices** powering real-time academic workflows backed by a **MongoDB** store. Building tools that internal users and business stakeholders rely on every day isn't a side project — it's been the shape of my last year of work.

On data and reliability: at PwC I spent three years on a distributed backend on **Microsoft Azure** integrating with **Microsoft CRM**, with event-driven processing, fault-tolerant retries over **SQL Server**, and parallelized batch ingestion that cut execution from hours to minutes. I'm comfortable across **PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB**, and I write SQL like I write code: readable, profiled, and tested. At Amazon I provisioned **Infrastructure-as-Code** on **AWS CDK** (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, IAM, CloudWatch) with multi-stage, multi-region CI/CD and rollback controls — the production-support posture HR-facing systems need.

On testing and quality: I've shipped under code-review discipline with unit and integration testing via **Mockito** at Amazon, and I'm fluent in **Jest, Vitest, and Cypress** for JavaScript-side coverage. I treat tests as part of the build, not an afterthought. I've also debugged production incidents through logs, metrics, and traces — the actual unglamorous work of keeping a system reliable.

What pulls me toward DoorDash People Applications is the cross-functional shape of the work. People tooling sits at an interesting seam — the systems serve internal stakeholders with high accountability, the data is sensitive, and the bar for thoughtful UX is high because the people using these tools are colleagues. That's an environment where engineering judgment compounds, and where outcome-oriented thinking actually changes how the company runs.

I'd welcome the chance to discuss further. Thanks for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Ajay Venkatesh